Exercise Programming Module — Lecture Summaries

The DiY Programme by Ekansh Taneja Fitness

Lecture 1 — What To Do When This Is NEEDED

Module 4 | Lecture 21

This lecture sets the foundation for the entire Exercise Programming module. It addresses the critical question of *when* structured exercise programming becomes necessary and what factors must be considered before designing any training plan.

Key Takeaways:

- Understanding the purpose of exercise programming before jumping into design
- Identifying personal needs, goals, and constraints before starting
- Recognizing when a structured programme is genuinely required vs. ad-hoc training

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Lecture 2 — Access To Equipment

Module 4 | Lecture 22

This lecture covers the concept of sustainability vs. optimality in training, and how access to equipment shapes your programme design. It is more important to be consistent than perfect in every single session.

Key Concepts:

Term	Definition
Sustainable & Enjoyable	Practices or activities that are done consistently and are pleasant to experience
Optimal	The best or most favorable outcome to given criteria/constraints — implies efficiency, effectiveness, and achievement of goals with minimal waste or effort

The Three Zones:

- **White Area** — Extreme & Rare (purely optimal, unsustainable for most)
- **Black Area** — Extreme & Rare (purely enjoyable but not productive)
- **Grey Area** — Most Favourable ✅ (balance of sustainable + enjoyable + near-optimal)

> **Recommendation:** Stay in the GREY AREA. White and Black zones are for rare cases where a client has a strict deadline-based goal (e.g., a photoshoot, professional competition). In Black and White zones, optimality is prioritized at the cost of sustainability.

A wise coach creates a near-optimal training plan while keeping sustainable and pleasurable aspects in mind. Factors like injuries, access to equipment, time commitments, and personal likes/dislikes determine how much you show up — and should be factored into every programme.

Lecture 3 — Design Your Workout Program

Module 4 | Lecture 23

This lecture dives into the framework for designing a structured workout programme from scratch. It covers the variables and decision points a trainee or coach must consider when putting a programme together.

Key Takeaways:

- How to structure training days, muscle groups, and exercise order
- Programming is a skill — not just selecting exercises, but organising them intelligently
- Aligning program design with individual goals (fat loss, muscle gain, strength, etc.)

Lecture 4 — Implementation Of Information

Module 4 | Lecture 24

After learning the theory, this lecture focuses on *how to actually apply* the information in the real world. A common failure point for most trainees is the gap between knowledge and execution.

Key Takeaways:

- Bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application
- Strategies to implement programming concepts into a real training routine
- Avoiding analysis paralysis — taking action with the information you have

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Lecture 5 — Balance Between Frequency

Module 4 | Lecture 25

Training frequency is one of the most debated topics in exercise science. This lecture explores how to find the right balance between how often you train each muscle group and your ability to recover.

Key Takeaways:

- Understanding training frequency: how often each muscle should be trained per week

- Higher frequency is not always better — recovery capacity must match frequency
- Individual factors (training age, lifestyle, recovery, schedule) determine optimal frequency
- Finding the sweet spot between stimulus and recovery

Lecture 6 — Packed With Vital Information

Module 4 | Lecture 26

A content-dense lecture covering multiple critical programming variables that every trainee must understand to build an effective workout plan.

Key Takeaways:

- Overview of all critical programming variables (volume, intensity, frequency, rest)
- How these variables interact with each other
- Common mistakes when programming and how to avoid them
- Practical rules to follow when designing your own programme

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Lecture 7 — Suitable For All Your Goals

Module 4 | Lecture 27

This lecture demonstrates how exercise programming principles can be adapted for *any* fitness goal — whether it is fat loss, muscle gain, strength, endurance, or general fitness.

Key Takeaways:

- Universal programming principles that apply across all fitness goals
- How to modify volume, intensity, and frequency based on your specific goal
- Why one-size-fits-all programmes rarely work — personalisation is key

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Lecture 8 — Recovery And Consistency To New Levels

Module 4 | Lecture 28

This lecture focuses on two crucial — and often overlooked — pillars of training progress: **RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion)** and **RIR (Reps In Reserve)**. Understanding both tools can dramatically improve your performance, recovery, and long-term consistency.

Key Concepts:

Tool	Description
RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion)	A subjective scale to measure how hard a set feels (typically 1–10). Useful for gauging daily readiness and adjusting intensity.
RIR (Reps In Reserve)	How many more reps you *could* have done before reaching failure. More precise and objective for tracking training proximity to failure.

Key Takeaways:

- Both RPE and RIR have their faults and advantages — using both together maximises results
- These tools help autoregulate training based on day-to-day recovery levels
- Having these tools in your arsenal can take performance, recovery, and consistency to new levels
- Knowing *when* to push hard vs. hold back is critical for long-term progress

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Lecture 9 — Practical Examples

Module 4 | Lecture 29

This lecture provides real-world, practical examples of how all the programming concepts covered so far are applied. It also explores

how training frequency interacts with other variables like volume and intensity.

Key Takeaways:

- Detailed walkthroughs of how to construct a training week using the principles learned
- Discussion of different types of sets and their role in intensifying and diversifying workouts
- How training frequency comes into play when other factors (volume, intensity) are locked in
- Advantages and disadvantages of **high frequency** vs. **low frequency** training
- Factors to determine which frequency approach suits you best

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Lecture 10 — Different Types of Sets

Module 4 | Lecture 30

A deep-dive into the various types of sets used in resistance training — understanding each type allows you to programme smarter, train harder when needed, and strategically introduce variation.

Key Types of Sets Covered:

- **Straight Sets** — Standard working sets with fixed reps and weight
- **Drop Sets** — Reducing weight and continuing without rest
- **Super Sets** — Two exercises back-to-back with no rest
- **Giant Sets** — Three or more exercises performed consecutively
- **Rest-Pause Sets** — Brief rest within a set to extend volume beyond failure
- **Cluster Sets** — Intra-set rest periods to maintain high quality reps
- **Mechanical Drop Sets** — Moving to a mechanically easier variation when fatigued

Key Takeaways:

- Each set type serves a specific purpose — intensity, volume, time efficiency, or novelty

- Advanced set techniques should be used strategically, not as a default
- Knowing when and how to apply each type is a core skill in exercise programming

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Lecture 11 — Lecture Discusses The Different Strategies

Module 4 | Lecture 31

This lecture delivers tailored strategies for trainees at different experience levels. A beginner stepping into the gym for the first time needs a fundamentally different approach from an advanced lifter with years of experience.

Key Takeaways:

- **Beginner Strategies:** Focus on movement quality, building habits, and progressive overload with simple programming
- **Intermediate Strategies:** More volume, increased complexity, introduction of periodisation concepts
- **Advanced Strategies:** Specific intensity techniques, higher volume blocks, programme variety
- Practical relatable examples are used throughout to illustrate each level
- Personalised recommendations based on training age and current capacity

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Lecture 12 — Designed Workout Splits And Programs

Module 4 | Lecture 32

This lecture presents pre-designed workout splits and full programme templates that can be directly applied or adapted for individual use.

Key Splits Covered:

- **Full Body Split** — Training all major muscle groups each session (ideal for beginners or low-frequency schedules)
- **Upper/Lower Split** — Separating upper and lower body training across sessions
- **Push/Pull/Legs (PPL)** — Grouping muscles by movement pattern
- **Bro Split / Body Part Split** — One muscle group per day (typically for advanced lifters with high volume demands)

Key Takeaways:

- No split is universally superior — the best split is the one you can follow consistently
- Each split has implications for frequency, volume per session, and recovery
- Templates are provided as starting points — they should be personalised over time

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Lecture 13 — Happy Lifting

Module 4 | Lecture 33

The final recap lecture of the core Exercise Programming module. With all resources and information at your disposal, this lecture ties everything together with specific recommendations across workout split selection, weekly training volume, and intensity for all levels.

Key Takeaways:

- Recap of all major programming concepts covered in the module
- Specific recommendations for:
  - **Beginners:** How to start, how much volume, which split to follow
  - **Intermediates:** How to progress and add complexity
  - **Advanced:** How to push past plateaus with smart programming
- In-depth walkthrough of a **complete workout template** covering:
  - Exercise selection
  - Volume organisation

    - Stimulus distribution
    - Session structure
- A reminder that the best programme is the one you actually enjoy and stay consistent with

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Lecture 14 — Effective Training Strategies (Part 1)

Module 4 | Lecture 34

Part 1 of a two-part lecture series covering advanced and effective training strategies. This lecture builds on the foundational programming concepts to introduce more refined strategies for maximising training outcomes.

Key Takeaways:

- Advanced training strategies for experienced lifters looking to break plateaus
- Evidence-based techniques to increase training stimulus without increasing injury risk
- Strategies focused on progressive overload, intensity management, and periodisation principles

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Lecture 15 — Effective Training Strategies (Part 2)

Module 4 | Lecture 35

The continuation and conclusion of the Effective Training Strategies series. Part 2 dives deeper into implementation and provides a comprehensive framework for applying these strategies in real training programmes.

Key Takeaways:

- Continuation of advanced training strategies introduced in Part 1

- How to sequence and periodise these strategies over weeks and months
- Final recommendations and a holistic approach to long-term programming for sustainable progress
- Practical tools and frameworks to take your training to the next level

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